

Glossary

Test Drive > Display systems

Ambient light: An all-directional light used to uniformly illuminate objects from all directions.

API: Short for 'Application Programming Interface', this is a standard programming interface which enables game developers to write applications to a standard without having to worry about the hardware implementations. API allows a single application to run

Pro. The former notched an impressive score of 2712 and the latter produced a stupendous score of 4509!

Moving on to the synthetic test based on the OpenGL API, we got to see a different story altogether. The Trident Blade XP, which managed to whip up 1078 marks in the 3D Mark 2001SE test, actually failed in the vulpine GLmark test. The Asus V3005 card based on the SiS 305 chipset could only complete the test in the lowest resolution

Stay away from...

- Older PCI based cards with 2 MB VRAM
- Cards based on chipsets like SiS 6215, Cirrus Logic 5440, S3 Trio 64V
- Older cards based on chipsets like SiS 6326 and Trident 9750. They feature the AGP interface support, but some of the chipsets in them do not have support for OpenGL based games. The low RAM onboard severely reduces performance because most of the games today require at least 8 MB of video RAM.

(640x480x16, the lowest detail). In this test the cards based on the Riva TNT2 M64 chipset showed severe artifacting, though they were able to complete tests without any hang-ups. The top TNT2 M64-based card in this test was the Pixelview Riva TNT2 M64, which scored 46.8 fps in the low-quality mode. This card was closely followed by the Maxforce card based on the same chipset. Though all the cards based on the various ATI chipsets managed to pass this test, none of them came close to offering any competition to cards based on nVidia's GeForce2-MX chipsets. Even the MX-200 based cards easily overtook them and produced impressive scores. The best ATI chipset-based card here again was the Ennyah Radeon VE; it was the only one close to hitting the 60 fps mark, and it also managed to return an average of 57 fps in low-quality mode.

REAL WORLD TESTS
Direct3D

Real world tests stress every component of a 3D graphics card to the maximum when the settings are upped. We used Evolva Ver944 as our Direct3D real world test benchmark. There were some parts in

